



Toshendra Sharma, Founder & CEO, NFTically; Ramkumar Subramaniam, Co-founder & CEO, Guardian Link; and Ankit Wadhwa, founder, CoinDCX **3.** **Aayush Ailawadi, Technology Editor & Presenter, Business Today TV, with Kunal Nandwani, Co-founder, Rajnish Kumar, Chairman, BharatPe; Subhash Chandra Garg, former finance secretary; and N.S. Nappinai, Advocate, Supreme former CEO, IDFC Foundation, ex-Group CHRO, Tata Sons, and former Global Partner, EY; and Rajkumar Nehru, Vice Chancellor, and Abhinav Ashwin, Partner, AZB Partners**

ing the workforce in this new technology was paramount.

As the debate veered towards regulation, Rajnish Kumar, former SBI chairman and current chairman of start-up BharatPe, made a daring prediction: “I would not be surprised to see crypto as a currency for international transactions over the next 10 years.” But former finance secretary Subhash Chandra Garg felt that the moment e-dollar or the digital dollar comes in, the global currency will retain the primacy it has today.

The next session, on taxation, saw tax experts expressing surprise that the government announced 30 per cent tax on gains from crypto transactions, but losses from one crypto asset will not be allowed to be set off against profits in another. That points to a perception issue. “We

can’t run away from the fact that the government at least perceives this to be speculative income,” said L. Badri Narayanan, Executive Partner, Laxmikumar & Sridharan.

The penultimate session saw politicians discuss whether crypto assets should be banned or regulated. While BJP MP and current Chairperson of the Standing Committee on Finance, Jayant Sinha, said that the government’s approach towards cryptocurrency is measured, Shiv Sena’s Priyanka Chaturvedi said India is missing out on the economic benefits of the crypto industry due to the government’s cautious approach. The opposition leaders were particularly unhappy about the government bringing in taxation into crypto assets without clarifying on their legality.

Finally, we get back to Rajeev Chandrasekhar. Apart from saying that buying crypto assets is legal, the minister also made clear that the pace of digital technology evolution has made it necessary for India to require a new digital law. “The basic law that today regulates cyberspace and the Indian internet is called the IT Act, which was enacted in 2000—in the internet age, 22 years is like three centuries. I think it is clear in our minds that we need a new digital law.”

Clearly, there’s a lot that is yet to happen. Watch this space. **BT**

With inputs from Nidhi Singal, Rajat Mishra, Anand Adhikari, Aakanksha Chaturvedi, Jhinuk Sen, Bismah Malik, Vidya S., Rahul Oberoi and Ashish Rukhaiyar